

9 questions every buyer asks about moving to Florida.

The real questions relocating buyers ask, with real Central Florida numbers. The two in gold are the ones that quietly derail deals when nobody raises them early. **Raise them first and your clients trust you more.**

1 What will home insurance actually cost?

\$2,000–\$4,000 / yr
TYPICAL IN ORANGE, SEMINOLE & OSCEOLA

Ignore the scary statewide headlines. Those are driven by coastal South Florida. Orlando sits 45+ miles inland, so Central Florida premiums run **well below the state average**, and newer homes with young roofs often land near the bottom of the range. Roof age is the biggest factor. Rates are also softening in 2026 for the first time in years.

2 What is a CDD fee, and does this home have one?

\$1,000–\$3,000 / yr
ON TOP OF HOA • RUNS 20-30 YEARS

A Community Development District fee is a bond that pays for roads and amenities in many newer master-planned communities. It sits **on top of the HOA** and shows up on the tax bill, where listings often bury it. Always check the tax record so your client sees the true monthly cost before they fall in love.

3 Is this home in a flood zone?

Zone X ≈ \$0–\$600
HIGH-RISK ZONES CAN RUN THOUSANDS

Flood damage is **not covered** by standard home insurance. The good news: most of inland Orlando sits in low-risk Zone X, where flood coverage is optional and cheap. Pull the zone before writing an offer, it can swing the payment by hundreds a month.

4 How do property taxes really work here?

~\$50K exemption
HOMESTEAD, PRIMARY RESIDENCE ONLY

No state income tax, and the homestead exemption cuts taxable value and caps annual increases. The catch: **the seller’s low tax bill does not transfer**. Taxes reset at the purchase price, so budget from the new assessed value, never the current owner’s bill.

5 When should we close to lock the tax break?

Own by Jan 1
FILE BY MARCH 1 • AIM TO CLOSE BY NOV

To claim homestead for a given year, your client must own and reside in the home by **January 1** and file by March 1. Late-year movers should target a fall closing to establish residency in time. Getting this right saves real money in year one.

6 How long does closing take in Florida?

30–45 days
FASTER WITH CASH • REMOTE-FRIENDLY

Florida is a title-company state, so closings are smooth and familiar. For out-of-state buyers, **remote and mail-away closings are routine**. Your client never has to fly down to sign.

7 Are the schools good, and how do we check?

Zoned by address
NOT BY CITY OR ZIP

School assignment follows the exact address, and quality varies block to block. Never assume from the town name. I pull the **assigned schools and ratings for every home** a family is serious about, before they get attached.

8 What about hurricanes?

45+ miles inland
ORLANDO’S BUILT-IN WIND BUFFER

A fair question deserving an honest answer. Storms weaken fast over land, and Orlando’s inland position is exactly why insurance costs less here. Newer homes meet strict wind codes, and a **wind mitigation inspection** can cut the premium 15 to 45%.

9 What does the real monthly payment look like?

P&I + tax + ins + HOA + CDD
THE ALL-IN NUMBER

The sticker price is only part of the story. The number that matters is the all-in monthly: principal and interest, plus taxes at the **new** assessed value, insurance, HOA, and any CDD. I build every relocating buyer this exact breakdown up front, so there are zero surprises after they move.

The agents who raise insurance and CDD fees **early** are the ones whose deals close. Send me a client and I walk them through all nine before they get attached to a house, and **you stay looped in the whole way.**